

fill the jobs that appear to be killing men. Today women set corporate policy, defend clients in lawsuits, cut into brain tissue in operating rooms, and run cities. Unfortunately, according to cardiologist Meyer Friedman and nurse Diane Ulmer, "The incidence of coronary heart disease is increasing rapidly among women." In *Treating Type A Behavior—And Your Heart* (Knopf, 1984), Friedman and Ulmer report that Type A professional and business women—those who hurry the most and get annoyed the quickest—suffer from coronary heart disease *seven times* more frequently than Type B women.

Nancy Mayer, in *The Male Mid-Life Crisis* (NAL, 1970), says that the body's ability to withstand stress may be finite. She reports that Dr. Hans Selye "first identified the stress syndrome that causes a chemical rallying of the body's defenses . . . Stress is a drastic wearing force, he found, and once each man's 'adaptation energy' is expended it cannot be replaced. . . ." If Selye is right, and our stress is work-related, we're literally wearing ourselves out on the job.

Today's executive men and women will most likely succumb to fast-lane killers like heart disease, cancer, stroke, emphysema, diabetes, and cirrhosis of the liver. None of those killers were among the top ten causes of death at the turn of the century. Grandpa's grandpa died of less esoteric diseases like diarrhea, typhoid, cholera, tuberculosis, and smallpox. That was before organization man, the gray flannel suit, and the information war. Before antismoking laws. Before three-Perrier lunches. Before softer-than-soft toilet tissue that feels like Wonder Bread on a roll. Before television.

Have you ever been to an old folks' home? An old folks' home provides harsh evidence of society's failure to provide a decent environment for aging for many people. You'll find it isn't an old folks' home at all. It's an old ladies' home. The one I visited had seventy-eight women and two men. Neither of the men came out to see me. Perhaps they were back in their rooms wondering what the hell they were doing there.